



Buying
Tips for
LCD Monitors

LCD monitors use liquid crystal filled grids activated by electric fields to create smooth, finely defined images. Quality varies somewhat for certain LCD monitors.

Resolutions

Make sure that the native resolution matches the one you use regularly. Also, look for models with a one-touch auto adjust feature that matches your screen display with your computer resolution.

Dead Pixels

A problem with LCD screens is dead pixels. This refers to pixels that are either always 'on' or 'off'. After hooking up the monitor, run a totally white screen and look for stray black dots, then switch to a black screen and check for white or coloured dots. A few dead pixels won't seriously impact your display. But too many dead pixels or dead pixels in the wrong place can be a constant irritation.

Digital or Analog Inputs

Almost all flat-panel displays support analog input, which is the standard for PC video. All PC and Macintosh systems can produce analog output. If you want a sharper display, you can get an LCD monitor with digital input, called DVI (Digital Video Interface). To use the DVI input, you'll need a special graphic card with a DVI output connector.

Delightful Displays

With LCD's appearing in the market, users now have a new display that provides a far crisper vision, emitting less amount of glare.

Going by the market scenario, the 15-inch LCD, which was once priced at around Rs 35,000 is now placed at an affordable price of Rs 25,000. However, the 17-inch and 18-inch category that houses models such as Samsung SyncMaster171 MP, still remains unreachable due to its high price. LCD monitors use minimal desk space, have a crisper display, low power consumption and minimized eye strain, since there is no radiation. The newer technology incorporated nullifies the ghosting and streaking of images. Viewing angles have increased to 140 degrees with a reduction of contrast and brightness.

Smart Tips

Viewable area: Monitor size (say 17-inch) is measured diagonally. However, there is a maximum viewable area specification that you need to pay closer attention to in CRT monitors. This would be in the region of about 13.8 inch viewable for a 15-inch model and close to about 16 inch viewable for most 17-inch monitors.

Dot pitch: Dot pitch plays an important role in the crispness of the image. The smaller the diagonal dot pitch, the crisper the image. Diagonal dot pitch is more critical than horizontal dot pitch. For instance, a horizontal dot pitch of 0.24 mm usually corresponds to a diagonal dot pitch of approximately 0.28 mm. Most 15-inch monitors come with 0.28 mm diagonal dot pitch, whereas for the 17-inch models it's between 0.24 mm to 0.28 mm.

Screen Geometry: Screen geometry refers to the accurate display of shapes such as circles, squares and polygons. The monitor should be capable of displaying images without any geometric distortion. In most inferior monitors you will find that circles end up looking slightly elliptical in shape.

Video bandwidth: The higher the bandwidth of the monitor, the greater the range of resolutions it can support. Ideally, you should look for support for 85 Hz at the resolution you normally use, to avoid the flicker that will invariably take place at refresh rates of 60 Hz. This can add considerably to reducing fatigue, especially for people that spend a major part of the day sitting in front of their computers.



Decision Maker

	Office productivity	Home and Internet	Gaming and graphics professionals
You need	A display that reproduces crisp text for office applications	You are looking for display that fits into your overall PC budget.	A large display with a high resolution support and excellent colour reproduction
Look for	15-inch monitors	14-inch, 15-inch, or 17-inch monitors	19-inch, or 21-inch monitors
Our pick	View Sonic E53 (CRT), Sharp LL-T15V1 (LCD)	Samsung 753S (CRT), Samsung 171 MP (LCD)	Samsung SyncMaster 955DF (CRT), LG StudioWorks 995e (CRT), LG StudioWorks 221U (CRT)
Price range	Rs 5,500 (CRT) to Rs 33,000 (LCD)	Rs 12,000 (CRT) to Rs 75,000 (LCD)	Rs 20,000 and above

